

Guide for women 40+ on navigating dating apps and alternative methods — Action Checklist

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TRACK YOUR APP USAGE

- ☐ **Track Your Daily App Usage:** Use your phone's screen-time settings or download a tracking app to measure exactly how many hours you spend on dating apps each week.
- ☐ **Complete the 7-Day App Usage Log:** Record the time of day, duration, emotional state before opening, and emotional state after closing every time you use any dating app for seven consecutive days.
- ☐ **Record Emotional States Before and After:** Note your feelings each time you open a dating app so you can identify which emotions—boredom, loneliness, anxiety—trigger your scroll behavior.
- ☐ **Identify Your Top Three Scroll Triggers:** Write down the three specific moments when you most often open apps without consciously deciding to, such as evening boredom or post-date disappointment.

BUILD STRUCTURAL BOUNDARIES

- ☐ **Choose Two Non-Negotiable App-Free Windows:** Pick specific time blocks, such as before 10am and after 9pm, where you commit to never opening any dating app regardless of willpower.
- ☐ **Delete All Dating Apps From Your Phone Entirely:** Remove the apps completely rather than just logging out, because re-downloading them later creates the friction you need to break the habit loop.
- ☐ **Set a Five-Minute Timer When You Open Any App:** Open your phone's timer the moment you start browsing and close the app immediately when it rings, regardless of where you are in a conversation.
- ☐ **Tell Someone About Your Boundaries or Set Phone Reminders:** Share your app-free windows with a friend or set calendar alerts so your commitments stay visible and harder to ignore.

DESIGN AROUND TRIGGERS

- ☐ **Replace Evening App Use With a Specific Alternative Activity:** When boredom hits at night, have a ready 替代 such as reading, journaling, or calling a friend instead of defaulting to scrolling.
 - ☐ **Create a Post-Date Rule to Wait Before Opening Apps:** Prevent quick rebound browsing after disappointing dates by imposing a 24-hour app-free period following any date.
 - ☐ **Schedule Social Activities During High-Risk Times:** Plan in-person gatherings, classes, or hobbies during weekends and holidays when loneliness spikes make you most vulnerable to excessive app use.
 - ☐ **Turn Procrastination Triggers Into Action Signals:** When you catch yourself reaching for the app to avoid something difficult, pause and do the harder task instead—this builds the discipline apps erode.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.